



School of Enrichment

Exceptional Early Childhood Education

Ages 2.5 - 6

School of Enrichment, Inc.

1880 NE Butler Market Road

Bend, Oregon 97701

Admissions & Classrooms: (541) 771.1257

Business Office: (541) 771.2275



Family Handbook

2026—2027



Capacity: 75 students/day

Ages: 30 months – 6 years

Hours/Days of Operation: 8:00am – 5:00pm Monday – Thursday & 8:00am – 4:00pm Friday

Months of Operation: year-round program

State Maximum Staff to Child Ratio: 1:10. See class descriptions for our ratios.

Currently Enrolled: 62 (this number is fluid)

Parent Handbook updated 01/11/26

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Welcome

Dear Families,

Thank you for your interest in School of Enrichment. Designed by parents and professionals for Central Oregon families; we believe in supporting families in their quest to find enriching, quality programs for their children.

School of Enrichment is committed to a growth mindset and continuing quality improvement. This parent handbook is updated annually and intended to apply to the entire school year, but may be altered depending on new research, developments, rules or standards. We will communicate any changes with you as they occur.

Parent communication is valued and practiced in our program, to ensure optimal experiences for your student and family. Our program recognizes and embraces different learning styles and meeting each child's individual learning style is a priority for our team. Our environment and curriculum support the diversity of children's learning and is continually evolving to meet and exceed each family's expectations. We are open to hear your questions, feedback, and goals today and every day.

Please note, School of Enrichment is a year round program, operating continuously, 12 months of the year. If a student wishes to discontinue enrollment for any season or reason, 30 days written notice is required. If you choose to reapply for future admissions, complete a new application to be added to our waitlist.

Thank you,

School of Enrichment

About Our Founder

Katie Brandow, LCSW Licensed Clinical Social Worker

Katie has been involved with School of Enrichment since the doors opened in 2007. Born and raised in Oregon, she has lived in Bend most of her adult life. She is mom to two daughters and genuinely believes that early childhood experiences in a supportive environment allows our youngest learners to feel safe, be seen and learn empathy. She struck out to create a program that equipped children who are ready to take on the world in a meaningful and healthy way.

Katie attended the University of Oregon where she received a Bachelor of Arts in Social Science with an emphasis in Sociology and went on to complete her Master's Degree in Social Work through Portland State University. In early 2007, Katie and the surrounding community recognized the need for a quality, enriching and balanced early childhood program in Bend. After several months of planning with learning specialists, researchers, social workers and early childhood education professionals, they opened the doors to an excited community of parents who were equally eager to have their child participate.

Katie spent 13 years in the non-profit mental health sector working with families in youth advocacy, child protection, family preservation and reunification services, and medical social

work. Katie is fascinated by brain development, developmental stages and the social emotional development of children. Katie's facilitated several evidence-based courses such as Early Words, Darkness to Light, Strengthening Families, and youth mentoring programs for the Family Resource Center and The Commission on Children and Families throughout Central Oregon.

Katie coordinates school operations and creates the systems to ensure that every student has optimal early childhood experiences. Katie passionately supports parents in finding trusted care with enriching opportunities so that parents can maintain a healthy life balance and truly trust that their kids are safe and thriving in our care.

When Katie is not at School of Enrichment, she loves to create food for her family, adventure near and far, spend time with her family and invest in her own self-care. She gratefully acknowledges the contribution of community partners who have brought invaluable insight, professional advice, and generosity in spirit that helped shape School of Enrichment's foundational years.

Teachers

Our professional and loving teaching team is committed to the career of early childhood development and creating optimal classrooms based on research-based best practices. This positive team is well supported, trained and engaged in the early learning community. Our warm group of professionals are committed to igniting a love of learning to best prepare your student for their elementary experience. School of Enrichment teachers are passionate about creating an ideal environment focused on your student's strengths, interests and developmental readiness. Our teachers value each other and have positive and communicative relationships with colleagues, students and families. Teaching teams are created to collaborate and deliver a dynamic environment that is specific to their classroom goals. They are confident and empowered to make decisions for their classrooms. School of Enrichment's heavily supported team allows us to truly follow the mission we've set forth to provide. Individual teacher biographies are highlighted on our website. We have a long history of hiring and retaining an amazing team at School of Enrichment. See our website for teacher bios!

Mission

School of Enrichment is an early childhood program providing unmatched and exceptional preschool and pre-k classes, created to ignite a love of learning. Parents find true peace of mind when their children are in our loving care.

Learning Philosophy

Our research-based classrooms provide an early childhood environment that integrates an experiential and multi-sensory approach to education that promotes individualized, optimal child development experiences and learning readiness and potential of the whole child.

Our environment and curriculum are inspired by both historical early childhood philosophies and research-based methods for teaching. We use strengths-based teaching practices that are child directed and teacher guided. We recognize that children have different and individual learning styles and embrace and celebrate diversity. School of Enrichment also recognizes each family and student have individual goals, beliefs and values and inclusiveness of these beliefs, goals

and values are present in our classrooms. Our teachers work closely with families to ensure all social emotional and academic goals are met. We believe that this philosophy is best practiced with a low teacher to student ratio ranging from a maximum of 1:6 or 1:9. The ratio for each classroom is posted on each classrooms parent information board.

School of Enrichment Goals

- School of Enrichment emphasizes individualized education, social emotional development, play based learning, experiential learning, introduction to academics and outdoor recreation. We don't simply develop the mind. We develop character, personality and potential. Your pride is our joy. It's all to prepare students for success in life.
- To provide a warm and nurturing environment where the young child's learning can thrive through play, activities of their choice and directed activities while maintaining close proximity and asking open ended questions. Our teachers are on the floor or at the tables with our students, monitoring, letting them play without unnecessary interruptions, validating feelings, using positive comments and feedback to encourage children's interests.
- Play. Kids learn by playing.
- To stimulate the young child's learning with activities in areas of reading and math readiness, science, art, music, language, motor skills, culture and ethics.
- To encourage the self-esteem of the young child through respect of cultural and ethnic diversity with the support of teacher, class, and school.
- To create a love of learning and develop a lifelong learner who challenges himself/herself daily for future school and life success.
- Life is all about balance and that balance begins at School of Enrichment. We offer a well-rounded balance of child directed and teacher guided activities, small and large group activities, routines and choices for our students.
- Scaffolding is the bridge to connect any gaps in learning. Scaffolding refers to a variety of instructional techniques used to move students progressively toward stronger understanding and, ultimately, greater independence in the learning process. The term itself offers the relevant descriptive metaphor: teachers provide successive levels of temporary support that help students reach higher levels of comprehension and skill acquisition that they would not be able to achieve without assistance. Like physical scaffolding, the supportive strategies are incrementally removed when they are no longer needed, and the teacher gradually shifts more responsibility over the learning process to the student. Scaffolding allows for a deeper level of learning and helps build connections until a student can use scaffold-type thinking autonomously. Not only do these techniques build upon the social emotional development of a child but also build early language skills, increased vocabulary and reading skills.
- Repetition is a natural way of learning. The technique *repetition* involves simply doing something over again. Repetition helps to strengthen and reinforce the impact of

the prior technique, hopefully to achieve its original desired effect. Extension techniques offer additional experiences that increasingly become more complex than the baseline concept. Extension lessons offer an opportunity for further exploration while provoking or sparking new enthusiasm or interest in the topic.

- Self-talk is simply talking about what we are doing. Self-talk can be used to verbalize everyday activities and when used more strategically to model positive messages to self, shaping cognitive connections and to encourage a healthy inner voice while stimulating related questions and beliefs. With parallel talk, the adult uses sentences to talk about the child, what they are doing, what they are seeing, label the feeling or action they are doing.
- We use open ended questions while joining children on the floor or at the table during play. We focus on their interests, acknowledge and validate their feelings, encourage their talk and play and maintain a close distance with each student at all times. We offer positive and constructive feedback with repetition and ask questions to extend their own thinking and ideas using self-talk and parallel talk.

Explorative Classrooms

Our environment is built for exploration and discovery. We are continually redesigning the environment to stimulate the developmental needs of children and promote growth in the areas of fine motor, gross motor, cognition, imagination, literacy, social and emotional development, and speech and language development. Children are given opportunities to explore, discover, problem solve and build a strong foundation for future learning experiences.

Integrative Learning Curriculum

Creativity is the core of our curriculum. The ability to create, think divergently and problem solve are all important skills necessary for success in our world today and the world of tomorrow. Teachers provide activities that integrate practical skills and imagination. We integrate the instruction of reading readiness, language arts, math and science with the areas of art, music, drama and movement.

We use a thematic approach in planning our activities. Keeping our student's interests in mind, we choose themes or units of study and base our activities on those themes. Activities are offered at a variety of levels so that children can choose an activity that is developmentally appropriate for them. Choice is an important part of our program. Children are encouraged to participate in all activities but they are able to do them at their level and in the amount of time they need.

School of Enrichment constructs a learning environment that encompasses a variety of diverse experiences within our classrooms. School of Enrichment includes the following programs based on your child's individual learning style, interest and readiness.

Core Concepts

- Social-Emotional: At School of Enrichment, social-emotional development is a part of all interactions with our students. We implement a variety of activities and strategies to

teach this, including the Conscious Discipline curriculum. This constant curriculum builds upon daily language and interactions to teach our students to identify and express their emotions, develop empathy and manage feelings of being confused, surprised, jealous, sad or upset. Children learn about themselves, develop executive functioning, build empathy and learn how to be a good friend through the use of art, role play and songs to grow socially and emotionally.

- **Music & Movement:** Many children find music meaningful and exciting! The music and movement is ever present at School of Enrichment. Song, dance and rhythm is a part of our daily routines. We explore a variety of cultural beats and rhythms with our bodies and minds. We may incorporate our learning from some of our songs into our seasonal performances throughout the year.
- **Creative Art:** Everyone is an artist. Best practices recognize the power of children's art on their development. We encourage creativity and the creation of new skills while using a variety of art methods, tools, materials, and introducing the language of art. Children are exposed to colors, shapes, and textures related to the theme.

Pre-K

Pre-K is the ideal class for students the year before kindergarten or who are kindergarten aged. Students are typically 4-5 years old. These classroom inspirations resulted from a community wish to develop a place for children that are motivated to explore the language of developmentally appropriate individualized academics, with a strong social emotional foundation. Research is clear that the goal of "reading" is only the tip of the iceberg. There are many foundational skills and processes under the iceberg that help children be long term efficient and fluent readers. Our qualified teachers guide these early learners through many activities that promote development of phonemic awareness and phonological processing. This is presented through fun, multisensory activities, individualized to meet the interests of each student. Individualized curriculum is designed by SOE staff and adapted to students specific needs. Our multi-sensory language and literacy approach will expose your child to fine motor development and phonics. The presence of play based language and literacy opportunities meets the needs of pre-kindergarten and kindergarten age children. Under the right circumstances and interest, we may utilize Learning Without Tears and Zoo Phonics as tools within our philosophy on individualized early language and literacy development. Our multi-sensory approach to teaching will build your child's foundational learning with meaning, motivation and enjoyment. School of Enrichment's pre-k program is enriched with a unique balance of play, socialization, emotional development and supplemental academics throughout your child's day. This class is designed for our older students, typically the year before kindergarten or year of kindergarten.

Preschool

This program is all about movement, music, exposure, routine, sensory experiences, gross and fine motor development. Our preschoolers are constantly progressing socially and emotionally by developing empathy, identifying and managing emotions, building upon understanding others and expressing themselves. Children are able to participate in the many learning opportunities throughout their day in a way that is meaningful and developmentally appropriate for them. We find that most children entering this program are

eager to join in and learn from our other learners. Individualized curriculum is designed by SOE staff and adapted to students specific needs to stimulate both your child's development and interests. We focus on the social emotional development of each student. Our preschool class is balanced with choice, engaging activities, play and endless opportunities to flourish. Our preschool curriculum allows each child to thrive at the stage they are in, allowing for attention to literacy exposure for our developmentally younger students.

If a student ages 30-36 months is new to being away from their primary caregiver, the recommended schedule is two to four half day classes a week. This is an ideal introduction to preschool. Considerations such as sibling schedule, developmental readiness and experience away from caregiver are considered, however our general recommendation is a half day schedule for our youngest students. If you elect a half day schedule and prefer a future full day schedule, we can put your student on the list to transition to full days as they show signs of readiness, pending availability.

Friday Fun Day

Friday Fun Day program is a group of preschool and pre-k students (ages 2.5-6) who join together for Friday Fun Day at School of Enrichment. This class is for both students who already attend School of Enrichment or enroll only for Fridays. The daily routine will mimic our Monday – Thursday programming, but the theme and focus of activities may differ. This evolving program focuses on experiential science, arts, sensory, movement, seasonal activities and as implied, FUN! Friday Fun Day is a full day program operating 8:00am – 4:00pm. All of the policies and procedures outlined in this handbook apply to Friday Fun Day.

Admissions & Fees

Children ages 2 ½ through ages 6 are enrolled at School of Enrichment. No child will be refused enrollment because of gender, race, orientation, or religion, or that of their parents.

Priority enrollment for current students:

- **School of Enrichment is a year round program, operating continuously, 12 months of the year, including summer. If a student wishes to discontinue enrollment, 30 days written notice is required. If you choose to reapply for future admissions, you will need to complete a new application to be added to our waitlist.**
- As a year round school, we do not have an option for seasonal absences. All students are enrolled 12 months out of the year. If you choose to unenroll your student for a season with the intention to return, your student will be taken off the roster and you can reapply by submitting a new application to be added to the waitlist. Future enrollment is dependent on availability and we are not able to guarantee your student's future enrollment if you choose to unenroll for any season or length of time.
- Priority enrollment link emailed **January 15, 2026.**
- Complete priority enrollment for your student and incoming siblings no later than **January 26, 2026.**
- 2026-27 \$550 non-refundable material fee due upon completion. Sibling material fee \$450.

- Schedules prioritized in order of receipt.
- If priority enrollment is not completed by **January 26, 2026**, follow procedures below for new students.

New students:

- Open Enrollment begins at the conclusion of Priority Enrollment, on February 2.
- Tours are conducted in person and virtually. Call to schedule.
- Admissions Open House April 2, 5:00 - 6:30 pm.
- Submit Classroom Enrollment Application and application fee of \$50.
- All applicants will be notified of enrollment status within two weeks of applying. Material fee and first months tuition is required to secure enrollment.
- If you are put on the waitlist, you will be notified as soon as an opening is available. Rolling admissions and wait list placement will continue based on availability.

Annual Material Fee: \$550 Due upon acceptance. Sibling material fee \$450.

Application Fee: \$50

Tuition, Material fee and Application Fee are non-refundable and non-transferrable.

Operating Hours

Monday – Thursday 8:00am – 4:00pm

Friday 8:00am – 4:00pm

Drop off is between 8:00am and 8:45am

Half Day Morning Program

8:00am to 12:00pm

Full Day Program

8:00am to 4:00pm

Pick up must be by 12:00pm or 4:00pm. Prompt pickups are required.

Schedule Options

- Monday through Thursday full day
- Monday through Thursday half day
- Monday & Wednesday half day
- Monday & Wednesday full day
- Tuesday & Thursday half day
- Tuesday & Thursday full day
- Friday Fun Day full day (add on to schedule or enroll for Friday only)

Tuition

Half Day Programs

2 days a week \$595 monthly

4 days a week \$1,120 monthly

Full Day Programs

2 days a week \$1032 monthly

4 days a week \$1,555 monthly

Friday Fun Day \$375 monthly

Tuition Agreement

School of Enrichment is a year round program. Families may choose to pay tuition annually or in monthly payments drafted on the 1st of each month in advance of receiving services. Monthly tuition is based on the total number of days in a school year and divided in 12 equal payments.

Siblings receive a 10% discount on the sibling's tuition rates, applied to their equal or lesser tuition amount, not the primary tuition. Sibling material fee is reduced to \$450.

There is no credit for vacations, inclement weather, school breaks, holidays, or any absences or closures throughout the school year. Please refer to the school calendar for school closures and observed holidays.

Automatic Clearing House (ACH): Based on School of Enrichment's 2026-27 tuition, families authorize School of Enrichment to initiate tuition and fees from your account via checking/saving account for payment to School of Enrichment. To update information provided in your ACH account, please complete an updated electronic ACH form by the 10th of the month prior to the change. School of Enrichment must receive updated account information no later than the 10th of the month in order to process your ACH for the following month. All authorizations will remain valid until you, School of Enrichment, or your financial institution voids this agreement. This ACH document is to remain in effect until School of Enrichment has

received 30 days notification from you to void authorization or if School of Enrichment withdraws your student.

Tuition is drafted on the 1st of each month or the following business day should the 1st occur on a weekend or holiday. If funds are not available (NSF) or if banking information provided is inaccurate, accounts will incur a \$25 reprocessing fee on the re-draft of monthly tuition via ACH. Re-draft will occur within 48 business hours. Please keep communication open if this applies to you to avoid a student withdrawal. Annual fees are withdrawn upon enrollment via stripe payment.

As a last resort, monthly tuition may be processed via a credit card. Credit card payments will incur a 3% processing fee. This credit card fee is subject to change.

Schedule Change: To increase, decrease or change your student's scheduled days, email program director marcee@schoolofenrichment.com. This process can only be completed via the online Schedule Change Request form. A \$35.00 fee will be applied upon submittal. Any changes in schedule are subject to approval and do not guarantee a change in your student's scheduled days. If a new schedule is approved, the ACH tuition amount will be adjusted for the following month or pro-rated requested on availability. Only parents/guardians of the child enrolled are authorized to submit a Schedule Change Request form. 30 day notice required to reduce schedule.

Tuition invoices are delivered electronically 5 days before the ACH draft and are automatically drafted on the 1st of each month. If the 1st is a holiday or weekend, it will process the following business day. I understand that my child may be withdrawn for non-payment of tuition. Onsite payments are not accepted.

Late Payments: If a payment cannot be processed, there is a \$25 bank fee.

There is no monetary or time credit given for holidays or days absent due to illness, vacation, or otherwise. Each month's tuition is prorated including school closures and tuition is the same every month of the year. Tuition is non-refundable and non-transferrable.

If a child is picked up late, the late pick up fee is \$20.00 for the first 10 minutes after their designated pick up time and \$20.00 thereafter for each 5 minutes of time. This payment will automatically be included on the following tuition invoice. There is no late fee for the first late pick up. If you have an emergency (i.e.: you're in the hospital, have a flat tire, etc.) interfering with picking up, please call the school. Timely pick-ups are critical to the smooth operation of our program.

We are a year round program, operating 12 months of the year. A minimum of 30 days written notification must be given for withdrawal from the program or reduce schedule. Tuition will accrue for 30 days from the date written notice is received. All tuition charges are non-refundable and non-transferable. If you unenroll for any amount of time, we cannot guarantee future enrollment.

I understand and accept that there is no credit for absences and days that the school is closed and that the tuition and annual material fee is non-refundable and non-transferrable. All fees and policies are subject to change without notice.

Drop Off & Pick Up

All students must be signed in and out daily by School of Enrichment staff. For your child's protection, we only release children to individuals specifically indicated on your authorized list and who present photo identification. Your child will not be released to anyone who is not identified as an emergency contact or authorized pick up on their enrollment form. The safety of your child is very important to us and any change in pick up information must be made in person. Please have any alternate authorized adult picking your child up be prepared to provide photo identification prior to your child being released. School of Enrichment will not release a child to a person who appears to be under the influence of a substance or in any way unfit to transport and care for a child.

Drop Off Procedures

1. Check your student into school with the staff member conducting check in.
2. Arrive on time to allow your student time to explore before circle time begins. Drop offs are between 8:00am and 8:45am.
3. Have your student walk in and carry their own belongings.
4. Help your student greet their teacher.
5. Teach your student to put personal belongings in their cubby and on their hook and change into their indoor shoes.

Pick Up Procedures

Be sure to arrive before your students pick up time to allow time to gather their items and check in with their teachers.

1. Greet your student and teacher.
2. Gather all personal belongings and items.
3. Read the white board to see what your student is doing at school.
4. Accompany your student at all times upon leaving the school.
5. Please close and latch all gates and doors.

Nutrition

All food is brought from home. We encourage and support healthy eating. Please ensure your child has eaten a healthy breakfast prior to coming to school.

For food safety, pack necessary items in an insulated lunch box with ice packs. All individual containers must be labeled with the student's name.

All students must bring a full reusable water bottle labeled with their first and last name.

Please let us know if your child has any food allergies or specific dietary needs and necessary accommodations will be made. If you wish to communicate any information about your child's eating habits or your family preferences, please discuss their specific needs with us. We will encourage small habits that build and create healthy and mindful eating for a lifetime, while also meeting the goals of your family.

Sweets Policy: To promote healthy choices, School of Enrichment asks that sweets/treats are not sent to school in your child's lunch or snack. This includes but is not limited to cake,

cupcakes and candy. Please save all treats for home. School of Enrichment will notify you if we serve treats for a special occasion.

The Early Learning Division has updated guidelines and expectations to meet USDA standards and ensure the nutritional needs of all students are being met. Please read carefully through the following sections so you are aware of what to pack each day. If students do not have the required food groups packed for lunch or snack, School of Enrichment is required to provide a replacement to meet USDA requirements, which is billed to the family.

Half Day Nutrition Requirements:

Half day students pack a hearty morning snack. If the snack needs to be kept cold, please send it in an insulated lunch box with ice packs. All individual containers must be labeled with the student's name. Snacks must meet USDA requirements and consist of food or beverage from at least two of the following food groups: Grains, protein (meat, or meat alternatives such as beans, peanut butter, yogurt or cheese), fruits and vegetables.

Snack examples that meet USDA requirements: yogurt & strawberries, cheese & crackers, cucumber & hummus, granola & banana, or a peanut butter sandwich on whole grain bread.

Please pack generously sized portions and provide utensils and a reusable napkin as needed.

Full Day Nutrition Requirements:

USDA requires that students have a milk or a nutritionally equivalent milk alternative packed for their lunch time meal. You can opt out of this requirement by signing a "Milk Opt Out" form.

Full day students pack an AM & PM snack that must be labeled "AM snack" & "PM snack". If the snacks need to be kept cold, please send them in an insulated lunch box with ice packs. All individual containers must be labeled with the student's name. Snacks must meet USDA requirements and consist of food or beverage from at least two of the following food groups: Grains, protein (meat, or meat alternatives such as beans, peanut butter, yogurt or cheese), fruits and vegetables.

Snack examples that meet USDA requirements: yogurt & strawberries, cheese & crackers, cucumber & hummus, granola & banana, or a peanut butter sandwich on whole grain bread.

Full day students also pack a healthy, well rounded lunch with at least *one* serving from each of the following groups: fluid milk or nutritionally equivalent alternative, grains, protein (meat or meat alternatives such as beans, peanut butter, yogurt or cheese). Each meal shall include *two* servings of fruits and/or vegetables.

Examples of lunches that meet USDA requirements:

Turkey sandwich on whole grain bread, raspberries, snap peas & milk

Pasta salad with vegetables, meat or cheese, a banana & milk

Peanut butter & strawberry sandwich on whole grain bread, carrot sticks & milk

Beans, rice, peas, kiwi & milk

Salami, pickles, crackers, olives & milk

Lunches must be in an insulated and labeled lunch box with ice packs. All individual containers must be labeled with the student's name. Please keep candy, pre-packaged goods such as

chips, fruit snacks, cookies, sugary yogurts and fillers only in addition to the required lunch items. Lunch at school is a great time to experiment with exposing your child to new foods. All food must be ready to eat as we are not able to warm food. Send warm items in an insulated thermos.

Please pack generously sized portions and provide utensils and a reusable napkin as needed.

What Your Student Should Bring

We've compiled an [amazon list](#) of the recommended and state approved items your student will need to have by their first day of school. Use this list to verify you have the correct items or you may purchase through this link and support School of Enrichment with a nominal amazon commission.

All students please bring:

- Extra Clothes: Please send 2 full sets of weather-appropriate extra clothes (bottoms, top, underwear, socks and sweatshirt) in a clear plastic bag, clearly labeled with your child's first and last name. These extra sets of clothing will be stored at the school.

Send your child in clothing appropriate for the current weather conditions. We go outside in all kinds of weather as long as it is safe for the children. In the summer, be sure to include sunhats and clothing to protect skin. In the fall/winter, it is important that you send them with a winter coat, hat, snowsuit, boots, and gloves. PLEASE LABEL EVERYTHING WITH FIRST AND LAST NAMES.

- Water bottle: Full reusable water bottle labeled with your child's first and last name.
- Indoor shoes: A pair of slip-on indoor shoes that will be kept in your child's cubby for the duration of the school year. They need to have hard soles and cannot be slippers. Crocs or Natives are the most common styles for indoor shoes. Please label them with your child's first and last name.
- Please do not bring any toys or special items from home.

Full day students additionally bring:

- Nap Time Pullups if needed: Parents are responsible for pull ups if their student uses them during rest time. Please send in a bag of pull ups labeled with your child's first and last name.
- Nap Mat: Parents provide a nap mat that is at least **1 inch thick, waterproof and made of a material we can disinfect and wipe**. Please label with your child's name.
- Bedding: Bedding for rest time will be brought on the first day of your child's school week and left for the duration of the week. It should be taken home on the last day of your child's school week to be laundered and brought back the next week. Bedding must fit in a container the size of a large shoe box. The popular fabric nap mat/bed roll/sleeping bag style mats do NOT fit in the nap boxes. Please do not bring one of those for your

child's bedding. Bedding can include a travel sized pillow, small blanket, and a comfort item if they need one.

- **Comfort Item:** A comfort item should not be something that has to go home every day like a special stuffed animal or security blanket. Comfort items cannot be toys such as dolls, action figures, race cars, etc. We recommend a small stuffed animal as it must be able to fit inside the large shoebox sized container with their nap items. Your child's comfort item will remain at school in their nap box for the entire school week and can be taken home on the last day of their week with their bedding to be laundered.

Rest Time Requirements

All full day preschool and pre-k aged children are required by the State of Oregon Department of Early Learning and Care to have a designated rest time at school. Children do not have to sleep, but we do adhere to the state mandated rest period. All students will rest on their mat for a minimum of 30 minutes. After this 30 minute period, children who are not asleep are able to get up and make quiet choices while the other children continue to rest. Every child who falls asleep during this time must be left sleeping until they wake up on their own or the designated rest time is over. We are not able to let children who no longer nap at home stay up and play, keep children awake per parent request, or wake them up after a certain amount of time per parent request. We understand that children may be transitioning out of napping during their time at School of Enrichment, but we cannot make any accommodations or exceptions to this state mandated rule. Some things we *can* do are place their nap mat in a lighter area of the room, remind the child they do not have to fall asleep before they lie down and not encourage sleeping by not rubbing their back, covering them up, etc. If you do not want your student to participate in the state required 30 minute rest time, please enroll in a half day class.

Special Needs

We will coordinate necessary accommodations for any child with special needs. Please let us know if your child has any special needs that require accommodations prior to their attendance. In many cases, School of Enrichment can work closely with therapists and specialists both in the classroom and community by accessing support, ongoing consultation, and supervision and/or planning.

Toilet Learning

All students must be able to communicate their bathroom needs and be willing to use the restroom to attend School of Enrichment.

We have limited availability for preschool students who are still mastering learning how to use the toilet. In these instances, preschoolers may wear a pull up (no diapers) until they master toilet learning. With consent, teachers can help teach students skills such as buttoning or unbuttoning pants as they master independence. These limited openings are for students who are actively learning this process and families who are currently supporting toilet learning at home and are willing to work with our team to master toileting.

Pre-K students must have mastered toilet learning to attend Pre-K.

School of Enrichment recognizes that children still have accidents and staff can assist with occasional easy-to-clean accidents when needed. With student permission, staff can assist with wiping after a student has attempted and do “check wipes” to clean up what a student may miss. Please be aware that our staff are not allowed to do extensive wiping/cleaning of private areas and can only assist minimally with wiping. If a student has a bowel movement accident that cannot be easily cleaned up or student does not consent to, parents will be called and must promptly come pick up or clean their child up. We do not have diaper changing facilities on site.

Transparent communication is provided and appreciated as we help all students with learning how to use the toilet.

Screen Policy

We will not watch television or participate in screen time at School of Enrichment. We recognize that there may be an abundance of wonderful gains that can be made with technology at home with 1:1 supervision. If a specialist, classroom visitor or volunteer uses a screen for any reason parents will be notified.

Babysitting Policy

School of Enrichment staff and teachers are not authorized to babysit, transport or otherwise care for students outside of the time they are attending School of Enrichment.

Changes at Home & Confidentiality

We are aware and supportive of the diversity of various families who join our school. Families come in all forms and we understand that the dynamic may change, often times unexpectedly. To help us give your child the most successful experience we can, we need to be informed of any changes in your family life. Sometimes changes that adults adjust to easily are more difficult for your children. If there is a marriage, move, separation or divorce, loss of a family member or pet, please communicate these changes with us. As we work closely with students and parents, we often learn of very private family matters. It is one of the ethics of our profession and the expectation of School of Enrichment that this information is kept confidential.

Holidays/Absences/Vacations

School of Enrichment’s school calendar is available on our website. Any other closure days will be posted at least one month in advance. Rarely, at no fault of School of Enrichment or its staff, we may have to close for unforeseen reasons or due to illness or event. If this occurs, we will first attempt to find substitute teachers. If this option is unavailable, then we will attempt to give notice at least 24 hours in advance, but this is not always possible. We do not offer make up days, refunds or transfers for missed classes or withdrawals.

Year Round Program: School of Enrichment is a year round program. If a student withdraws for any reason or season, we cannot guarantee future enrollment should a family wish to return. See Tuition Agreement and Admissions & Fee’s section.

Vacations: Please notify the school in advance when you know your student will be on vacation. *Please note, tuition rates remain the same regardless of vacations.*

Absences: Please notify School of Enrichment as early as possible when your child is going to be absent due to illness. If your child has a contagious illness, please let us know so that we can alert other families.

Inclement Weather Policy: School of Enrichment follows Bend-La Pine's School District weather advisory notices. If Bend-La Pine School District closes or has a delayed start to the school day due to adverse weather conditions, then School of Enrichment also delays or closes for the day. In the case of a delayed start, all morning programs are canceled and full day students arrive two hours after the original start time at 10:00am. If Bend-La Pine School District is not in session, or there are other weather related circumstances specific to School of Enrichment only, School of Enrichment will determine if it is safe to attend school. Parents can check any number of sources to determine if school is delayed or closed:

1. Sign up for text alerts from School of Enrichment. Text the word INFORMED to 844-609 9908
2. Sign up for text alerts from Bend La Pine School District.
3. Call the Bend La Pine hotline, which will be updated with weather delay or closure information: English 541-323-7669 or Spanish 541-355-0044.
4. Tune in to local media.
5. Check your email; when possible an announcement is emailed as soon as the closure or delay is confirmed.

Adverse Weather Disclaimer: School of Enrichment strives to keep our campus as safe as possible amidst challenging weather conditions. Unexpected weather patterns or freezing can create hazardous conditions. Please move slowly and safely when conditions are extreme. Accidents can happen even when snow is shoveled, ice melt is spread and signs are posted. Be prepared for these conditions and only enter them if you are comfortable.

Preparedness Plan

In the event of a fire or other natural disaster, an emergency preparedness plan is maintained at School of Enrichment, which specifically outlines a course of action for the following areas:

1. Designation of administrative authority and faculty assignments.
2. Contingency plan for fires, floods, and earthquakes.
3. Means of emergency exit.
4. Emergency transportation arrangements.
5. Means of contacting local agencies, including the fire department, law enforcement agencies and any other disaster authorities.
6. Means of contacting parents or other designated adults through the use of emergency contacts authorized by parents.
7. If we have to evacuate, our plan is to meet in our back play yard or if that is not a safe choice our secondary location is Canal Row Park 1630 NE Butler Market Road Bend, Oregon 97701.

Health Policy

A child may not attend school with any of the following: fever over 100.0 F, diarrhea, vomiting, nausea, severe cough, unusual yellow color to skin or eyes, persistent yellow or green mucus from nose, skin or eye lesions, eye redness and drainage, rashes that are weeping or pus filled, difficult breathing or wheezing, lice or nits, or complaints of severe pain. If your child gets any of

these symptoms, they will be asked to lie on a mat and stay isolated from the other students. You will be called immediately and asked to come get your child.

If your child is ill with any of the conditions described above, they must remain out of school for at least 24 hours.

Please see below for specific guidance on when to keep your student home:

Fever

May return after remaining fever-free for at least 24 hours without the use of fever-reducing medication.

Cough

Students should stay home if they have a persistent cough that is not yet diagnosed and cleared by a licensed health provider OR any acute cough illness that is frequent or severe enough to interfere with participation in usual school activities. May return after symptoms have been improving for 24 hours (no cough or cough well controlled.)

Diarrhea

May return after 48 hours after diarrhea resolves OR after seen and cleared by a licensed healthcare provider.

Vomiting

May return after 48 hours after last vomiting episode OR after seen and cleared by a licensed healthcare provider.

Norovirus

If your child shows symptoms of the Norovirus or tests positive for the Norovirus, they must remain home 72 hours after the last episode of vomiting.

Eye Redness and Drainage

Students should stay home with unexplained redness of one or both eyes OR colored drainage from the eyes OR symptoms such as eye irritation, pain, redness, swelling, or excessive tear production. Students may return after symptoms have been resolved OR after being seen by a licensed healthcare provider and indicated medication has been started.

Skin Rashes or Sores

Students should stay home with a rash that has not been diagnosed by a healthcare provider OR if new sores or wounds are developing OR if rash, sores or wounds are draining and cannot be completely covered with a bandage. May return after rash is resolved OR until sores and wounds are dry or can be completely covered in a bandage OR after being seen and cleared by a licensed healthcare provider.

Other health considerations:

Outbreaks

School of Enrichment will follow all guidelines set forth by the Oregon Health Authority and Deschutes County Health Department regarding COVID or any other illness or outbreak. Updates to health policies regarding specific illnesses will be communicated to families.

Medication

Prescription and non-prescription medications will only be given to your child with a signed Medication Release form. All medications, prescription or non, must be given to a teacher and cannot be kept in backpacks, lunchboxes or cubbies. Common non-prescription medications are lip balm, lotion, hand sanitizer and sunscreen. Teachers will administer and document when medication is given. When possible, please dispense medications at home.

Allergies/Asthma

If a student has asthma or an allergy that requires treatment, it is Oregon State law that an Allergy Plan is filled out and kept on file at the school. There is a place on the Enrollment Form to note allergies, but if your child has an allergy and/or asthma that requires a treatment, we ask that you reach out to the director to fill out the Allergy Plan prior to your child's attendance. The Allergy Plan will assure that all SOE staff members can act appropriately to your child's allergy if needed.

Sunscreen

Sunscreen is considered a medication and cannot be applied to your child at school without written consent. If you would like your child to use sunscreen at morning recess, please apply sunscreen to your child *before* they arrive at school. We do not apply sunscreen for morning recess unless requested. If they attend the full day program and you'd like sunscreen reapplied for afternoon recess, please provide non-aerosol sunscreen labeled with your child's full name directly to the teacher – sunscreen must be kept in a specific container by the SOE staff and cannot be kept in cubbies or backpacks and will remain at the school for the entire season.

Health Disclaimer

School of Enrichment reserves the right to send a student home or ask them to remain home, outside of the above mentioned scopes, if it's in the best interest of the health and safety of the other students and staff. We prioritize the health and safety of our students and staff and do not make these decisions lightly. We ask parents to do their best to keep sick children home until they are healthy and we will do the same.

Incident and Injury Reports

All incidents and injuries are reported in writing via an Incident or Injury Report form. Minor accidents such as cuts and scrapes will be treated with soap and water, bruises and bumps will be treated with ice packs. Certified personnel may administer additional first aid. If an injury is serious or concerning or if emergency treatment is necessary, parents will be notified immediately. Parents will receive an Injury Report related to any physical injury or an Incident Report related to any unusual event that may occur at School of Enrichment, that a parent will be asked to sign before departure.

Any accident or injuries that occur while your child is on the school premises shall be reported to you, in writing, describing the nature of the injury and actions taken. If emergency medical care is required, 911 will be called. Parents will be called first if possible. Parents are responsible for any emergency service charges.

Guidance Policy

Positive classroom behavior begins with adequate supervision, adaptation to the environment, and other strategies that prevent challenging behavior from occurring. At School of Enrichment,

we believe that the majority of many acting out behaviors can be prevented with supervision, redirection, and praise for making positive choices.

Teachers will be within sight and sound of students at all times. They monitor student's play for appropriate child to child interaction, intervene when necessary, and proactively guide students to make positive choices. Our teachers get to know individual temperaments, recognize each student's brain state before intervening, and monitor all students for frustration and anger, and redirect when necessary. We help each child recognize and name their feelings, develop self-control, empathy, patience and respect for others. We teach students skills to communicate healthfully and respectfully.

Physical restraint will only be used in critical circumstances such as if the student is putting themselves or others in immediate danger. A caregiver will be notified in writing and a written safety plan will be created and followed by all staff if this occurs more than one time during a student's enrollment.

THE RIGHTS STUDENTS HAVE IN OUR CLASSROOMS

- I have a right to be treated with kindness in this room; this means that no one will laugh at me, tease me or insult me.
- I have a right to be myself in this room; this means that no one will treat me unfairly because I am big or small, fast or slow, boy or girl.
- I have a right to feel safe in this room; this means that no one will threaten me, bully me, push me or destroy my property.
- I have a right to be heard in this room; this means that no one will yell or shout, and my opinion will be considered in any plan we make.
- I have a right to learn about myself in this room; this means that I will be free to express my feelings and opinions without being interrupted or criticized.

THE TECHNIQUES TEACHERS USE TO GUIDE CHILDREN

- Environments are set up to reduce conflict and/or frustration.
- Adults model appropriate behavior for the children.
- Praise is given for appropriate and safe choices.
- Classrooms have a "safe space" where kids can de-escalate from big feelings.
- Giving encouragement.
- Setting age-appropriate rules/boundaries and gently yet firmly holding those boundaries.
- Consistency amongst all SOE team members in the way they handle situations.
- Creating routines so children know what to expect.
- Teaching compromise.
- Teaching that mistakes are how we learn.
- Taking an individualized approach to each child so they can be met at whatever level they are on.
- Listening and validating children's feelings.
- Redirection.
- Offering alternatives to inappropriate or unsafe behaviors.
- Giving options and choices.
- Using positive language such as "use walking feet" versus "don't run."
- Involving the children in problem solving when applicable.
- Clearly explaining natural and logical consequences to actions.
- Implementing "calm down tools" such as breathing balls, squish toys, pop-its, etc.
- Staff remain calm even in heightened situations and always have another staff member to take over if they need to step away and reset.

- Mantras and breathwork are utilized by staff prior to approaching a triggering or stressful situation so they can enter with a calm, helpful energy.
- Using our safe space to provide a child with space, strategies or support when experiencing big feelings.
- While narrating what they are doing, staff may gently move a child's body away from other people if they are creating an unsafe space for others and are not able to control themselves at that moment. For example, "you may move your body over here or I can help you move your body."

Safety Policy

Safety is always School of Enrichment's foundational priority. Our school rules are "Be safe, be kind, listen to others." Staff members are always within sight or sound of every student.

Supervision is the best way to keep our school safe and prevent incidents of any kind. The importance of quality supervision and appropriate engagement is the cornerstone of School of Enrichment's philosophy. We encourage students to safely explore their emerging early childhood development under the guidance of a qualified School of Enrichment staff member. We strictly follow all rules set forth by the Department of Early Learning and Care (DELIC), the agency which manages our certification. DELIC requires several things, including that we share how we manage injuries, potentially toxic and prohibited substances in this safety policy.

Injury Prevention: Our facility has age and ability appropriate equipment and materials. Staff watches closely and monitors all activities to prevent injury. Anything broken or proven to be not appropriate will be disposed of or stopped immediately.

Potentially Toxic Substances: Any potentially toxic substances, such as pesticides, will be used when children are not present with the appropriate amount of "recovery" time to be safe for the children to be present again. Potentially toxic substances will be kept off campus or in a locked cupboard.

Prohibited Substances: Prohibited substances will not be allowed on the premises. If they are discovered or seen, School of Enrichment staff will call the appropriate authorities to collect and dispose of them.

Mandatory Reporting

The State of Oregon observes the mandatory reporting policy. Under these guidelines, all staff, volunteers, parents and adults in and around our school are mandated reporters of suspected child abuse of any form. The hotline number to call for suspected abuse and neglect in Oregon is 855-503-7233.

Parent Communication & Feedback

Communication with families is an extremely important piece to your child's education. We ask that all communication be kept professional through the school phone number or school emails. Please do not ask staff for their personal phone numbers or emails. Conferences are scheduled annually and at the teachers or parent's request as necessary. Teachers will communicate regularly about how your child is doing in the classroom via verbal conversations at pick up and drop off, handouts in your child's file folder, your class portion of the monthly newsletter, email, phone calls, communication whiteboard and parent

communication center. Please feel free to contact us if you have questions or concerns. School of Enrichment will provide regular announcements via email, in our monthly newsletter, with signs on the doors and on each class's communication whiteboard.

It is School of Enrichment's policy that every family has the opportunity to share their goals and ideas related to their child's education and development. Initial information is collected with the Enrollment Form. This comprehensive document requests detailed information about the child and family including developmental history, interests, preferences, fears, changes at home, family members, sleep patterns, nutrition, and routines. School of Enrichment receives ongoing feedback in the following formats including but not limited to: annual anonymous surveys, parent meetings, student assessments, email and verbal communication.

School of Enrichment completes an annual comprehensive assessment. The assessment allows us to determine areas of strengths and topics to focus on throughout the school year. Upon request, School of Enrichment can provide families with a detailed progress report with information specific to academics, behavior and social emotional development. If School of Enrichment has an idea to enhance the wellbeing and/or development of a student or if a family has concerns or questions and requests support, the School of Enrichment team schedules a conference with the student's family. Based on the specific concern or idea, School of Enrichment may offer specific parenting and child development information or we may refer a family to parenting education resources or other community resources such as a play or behavioral therapist. If there is any question of delayed development, learning differences or special needs, School of Enrichment directly supports the family in accessing and connecting to the resources available in our community that can facilitate supports with learning differences or the social emotional development of the child. Should the need for an interpreter arise, School of Enrichment will coordinate this service if possible.

School of Enrichment welcomes all parent/guardian feedback. Please direct all questions, concerns, and/or grievances to our administrative team.

We are certified by Department of Early Learning & Care (DELIC) and have biannual written certification reports available for any parent/guardian to view in our administrative offices. Parents/guardians can access information about all centers via the childcare safety portal. Certification rules and information on the child care safety portal are available at <https://www.oregon.gov/delic/pages/default.aspx>

Parent Volunteer & Visitor Policy

We welcome parents to contribute to our program, but is not required or expected. If you have a special skill or hobby, please let the school know. Please talk with us about the best time and way to become involved.

All visitors must check in at the main office upon arrival. They will sign in on the visitor log upon entering the building and sign out upon departure. There are "visitor" stickers that visitors should have on if they are walking around the school. Visitors are not allowed to have any unsupervised time with students. There are no exceptions to this policy.

Parent Authorizations

I have read and accept the conditions outlined in the Parent Handbook, the Classroom Application, Enrollment Form, and the Tuition Agreement. These agreements are effective for the duration of time my child is enrolled at School of Enrichment.

I understand that every effort will be made to contact me in the event of an emergency requiring medical attention for my child. However, if I cannot be reached, I hereby authorize School of Enrichment to transport my child to the hospital and to secure the necessary treatment. I understand the teachers at School of Enrichment are trained in the basics of first aid and I authorize them to give my child first aid and CPR when appropriate.

I hereby give permission for my child to be cared for by School of Enrichment and for my child to use all the play equipment and participate in all activities of the school.

I hereby grant permission for my child to leave the school premises under the supervision of the staff members for planned neighborhood walks or field trips.

I hereby release and hold harmless School of Enrichment, its staff and agents, from any loss or damage to toys, clothes, or any other personal items or articles. I relieve School of Enrichment, its teaching staff and specialists of all responsibility for accidents and injuries, claims, damages or other liabilities for injuries to or damage by my child both on and off the premises, which are not a result of gross negligence by the school, its staff or agents.

I grant permission for my child to be included in photographs connected with School of Enrichment. My child may be photographed for publicity or news purposes.

I hereby give permission for School of Enrichment to include my information in a parent directory to be used for social events and gatherings.

Withdrawal

Parents wishing to withdraw their student from the program or reduce their schedule must give a 30-day notice in writing. Application fee, material fee and tuition are non-refundable and non-transferrable. If School of Enrichment has concerns about your student's enrollment, the school will take all steps necessary to inform and work with the student's parents to find a solution that will allow the student to succeed and remain a student at the school. In the event that a solution is unable to be found or if the emotional or physical wellbeing and safety of other students and/or staff is put in jeopardy, School of Enrichment reserves the right to withdraw a student from the program.